Inspection Report

The Dallas World Aquarium

1801 N Griffin St
Dallas, TX 75202

Customer ID: **6545**

Certificate: **74-C-0392**

Site: 001
The Dallas World Aquarium

Type: ROUTINE INSPECTION

Date: 21-JUL-2026

2.40(b)(3)

Attending veterinarian and adequate veterinary care (dealers and exhibitors).

The facility failed to effectively observe animals to assess their health and well-being and convey timely and accurate information on problems of animal health, behavior and well-being to the attending veterinarian for the following animals:
USDA inspectors observed an adult Many-Banded Aracari, named “Dewey,” that was unable to consistently perch on an appropriately sized perch. About every 10-15 seconds, the animal slipped and was unable to firmly grip the perch. When asked if the veterinarian had seen the animal for this concern, the facility representative indicated that it had not and that facility staff had not observed the issue.
Keepers observed an adult Bearded Saki named “Half-Beard” (22M007) to have a new injury to its left hand on June 4, 2026. Daily observation notes from that day indicate “Half-Beard’s finger remains slightly swollen. The bone remains exposed and white.” The animal has a history of self-inflicted behaviors with its most recent injury to the tail on April 2, 2026. A medical entry dated March 11, 2026, documents that this individual has already self-amputated a portion of its right third digit. Despite this, the facility did not report the animal’s condition to the attending veterinarian.

Failure to timely and accurately communicate problems of animal health to the attending veterinarian can result in longer durations of pain and distress, and a worse prognosis.

Ensure there is direct and frequent communication to the attending veterinarian.
Correct by August 5, 2026.

3.58(a)

Classification and separation.

The facility housed a rabbit with two adult Burrowing Owls in the same enclosure. While the enclosure provided sufficient space, shelter, and access to food and water, rabbits are a species that are not permitted to be co-housed with any other species, unless for specific scientific purposes. Housing rabbits with other species may result in injury or compatibility issues. Correct by ensuring rabbits are not housed in the same primary enclosure with any other species of animals.
Correct by August 5, 2026.

3.78(b)

Prepared By: E RODRIGUEZ
USDA, APHIS, Animal Care

Date: 06-OCT-2026

Title: VETERINARY MEDICAL OFFICER

Received by Title: Facility Representative

Date: 06-OCT-2026

Inspection Report

Outdoor housing facilities.

An outdoor enclosure housing pygmy marmosets does not provide protection from the sun. The enclosure has clear plastic corrugated roofing for protection from inclement weather but does not provide adequate shade.

Failure to provide adequate shade exposes the animals to direct sunlight for extended periods, increasing their risk of heat stress and discomfort.

Correct by ensuring nonhuman primates in outdoor housing facilities are always provided adequate shelter from the elements, including direct sunlight. The housing must provide protection from the sun, rain, snow, wind, and cold, and from any weather conditions that may occur.
Correct by August 5, 2026.

3.131(d)

Sanitation.

The facility's current program for the control of insects is ineffective. Multiple live cockroaches were observed in and around the enclosures for the giant anteaters in the "Bridge" section of the facility. The walkways in front of the enclosures contained multiple dead cockroaches. The facility confirmed they currently spray for cockroaches; however, the presence of live cockroaches indicates that the program is ineffective.
Pests such as cockroaches can adversely affect the health and well-being of the animals by spreading disease and contaminating food, surfaces and animal housing areas.
A safe and effective program for the control of insects, ectoparasites, and avian and mammalian pests shall be established and maintained.
Correct by August 18, 2026.

3.150(a)

Facilities, general.

The housing facilities for various avian species are not being kept in good repair.
Numerous metal beams that comprise the enclosures throughout Aviary 1901 were severely rusted. The rust covered large portions of the beams, and was dark reddish-brown to nearly black, indicating more than surface rust. The beams had a rough, crust-like build up where the metal surfaces have deteriorated. An enclosure in Aviary 1901 containing one adult Curl-Crested Aracari had a broken lock on its door. There was no additional method to secure the bird inside the enclosure. An enclosure housing one toucan above the female giant anteater had a hole in the metal wiring approximately 2 inches by 2 inches in size; the exposed ends of the wiring created sharp points. Multiple bird cages throughout Aviary 1901 had broken sections of wiring that created sharp points.

Housing facilities with sharp points created by poorly maintained wire pose a risk of injury to the birds housing in them.

Correct by ensuring that bird enclosures are maintained in good repair, protect the birds from injury and restrict other animals from entering.
Correct by September 30, 2026.

Prepared By: E RODRIGUEZ
USDA, APHIS, Animal Care
Date: 06-OCT-2026

Title: VETERINARY MEDICAL OFFICER

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Date: 06-OCT-2026

Inspection Report

3.152(b)

Facilities, outdoor

The “Bridge” area primary enclosures that house several adult Black Mandible Toucans do not provide protection from the sun. The enclosure has clear plastic corrugated roofing for protection from inclement weather but doesn’t provide any shade from direct sunlight.

Failure to provide adequate shade exposes the animals to direct sunlight for extended periods, increasing their risk of heat stress and discomfort.

Shelter must be adequate to protect the birds from any adverse weather conditions and constructed to provide sufficient space to comfortably hold all of the birds at the same time. Outdoor housing facilities must provide adequate shelter appropriate to the species to allow the birds to access protection from direct sunlight in order to ensure their welfare.
Correct by August 5, 2026.

3.153(a)(2)

Primary enclosures.

An outdoor enclosure containing two adult Wattled Guans provided perches that were not appropriate for this species. The perches consisted of 2x4 wood boards mounted so that the 2-in side was vertically situated. Improper perch size, shape, and texture can lead to health issues like pododermatitis and put strain on the bird’s feet and legs. If the enclosure houses birds that rest by perching, there must be perches available that are appropriate to the age and species of the birds housed therein and a sufficient number of perches of appropriate size, shape, strength, texture and placement to comfortably hold all the birds in the primary enclosure at the same time, including birds that are ranked low in a dominance hierarchy.
Correct by August 5, 2026.

3.154(b)

Environment enhancement to promote psychological well-being.

The facility does not have an environmental enhancement plan (EEP) approved by the current attending veterinarian. The current attending veterinarian started on July 20, 2026, the day of the inspection and has not approved the environmental enhancement plan. Many enclosures were bare with only perches and their food receptacles present. Failure to implement and follow an EEP as outlined can negatively impact the health and well-being of the animals. Exhibitors must develop, document, and follow a species-appropriate plan for environmental enhancement that is approved by the attending veterinarian to adequately promote the psychological well-being of birds.
Correct by August 5, 2026.

3.155(a)

Feeding

Inspectors identified expired supplements in the bird nursery area. A Probios supplement expired April 25, 2025, a vitamin mix without an expiration date, and Auklet vitamin expired April 2025.

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USDA, APHIS, Animal Care
Date: 06-OCT-2026

Title: VETERINARY MEDICAL OFFICER

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Date: 06-OCT-2026

Feeding expired supplements to birds can compromise their health by provided degraded nutrients, which may result in reduced effectiveness.

The food must be wholesome, palatable to the birds, and free of contamination.
Correct by August 10, 2026.

3.155(b)

Feeding

Food receptacles in the jungle area holding ½ cut papayas were severely rusted with deep fissures and swollen areas that make the surface unable to be sanitized.

Failure to appropriately maintain clean food receptacles promotes unsanitary surfaces that can harm the birds' health upon ingestion of contaminated food.

Food receptacles must be kept clean and sanitized.
Correct by August 10, 2026.

3.158(a)(1)

Cleaning, sanitization, housekeeping, and pest control.

The facility is not removing excreta and food waste from the primary enclosure as often as necessary to prevent excessive accumulation of feces and food waste. USDA inspectors observed old food accumulated (over a dozen pieces of desiccated rabbit remains) in and around the Harpy Eagle enclosure in the netting above Aviary 1901.

Failure to regularly remove excreta and food waste creates unsanitary conditions that can be detrimental to avian health by increasing the risk of disease and attracting pests.

Excreta and food waste must be removed from the primary enclosures and from under and around primary enclosures as often as necessary to prevent excessive accumulation of feces and food waste, to prevent soiling of the birds contained in the primary enclosure, and to reduce disease hazards, insects, pests, and odors.
Correct by August 5, 2026.

3.158(d)

Cleaning, sanitization, housekeeping, and pest control.

The facility's current program for the control of insect and mammalian pests is ineffective. Aviary 1901 has multiple enclosures housing various species of birds that show signs of heavy ant activity. Extensive amounts of ants were present in the fresh food, on food receptacles and throughout enclosures for a vast majority of the outdoor bird enclosures. Live cockroaches were seen on the walls and within the enclosures of the birds housed in the Bridge area. Although the facility sprays, the current program is not effective as evidenced by the findings above.
Pests such as rodents, cockroaches and ants can adversely affect the health and well-being of the birds by spreading disease and contaminating food, surfaces and animal housing areas.
A safe and effective program for the control of insects, ectoparasites, and avian and mammalian pests shall be

established and maintained.
Correct by August 18, 2026.

This inspection and exit interview were conducted with the facility representative.

You may appeal all or part of any inspection report by submitting a written statement contesting the findings—along with any supporting documentation—to the Deputy Administrator. Appeals of routine, focused, or attempted inspections must be received within 21 days of report issuance as shown by the signature line of this report.

Appeals may be sent by email to AnimalCare@usda.gov.

Appeals sent by mail should be addressed to:
Deputy Administrator
APHIS Animal Care (AC)
U.S. Department of Agriculture
2150 Centre Avenue, Building B
Mailstop #3W11
Fort Collins, CO 80526-8117

Additional Inspectors:

Sarah Roloff

CODY YAGER

Lynh Ly, VETERINARY MEDICAL OFFICER

Prepared By: E RODRIGUEZ
USDA, APHIS, Animal Care

Date: 06-OCT-2026

Title: VETERINARY MEDICAL OFFICER

Received by Title: Facility Representative

Date: 06-OCT-2026

United States Department of Agriculture
Animal and Plant Health Inspection Service

Customer: 6545
Inspection Date: 21-Jul-2026

Species Inspected

Cust No	Cert No	Site	Site Name	Inspection
6545	74-C-0392	001	The Dallas World Aquarium	21-JUL-2026

Count	Scientific Name	Common Name
000001	*Saguinus imperator*	EMPEROR TAMARIN
000003	*Tachyglossus aculeatus*	SHORT-BEAKED ECHIDNA
000003	*Choloepus hoffmanni*	HOFFMANN'S TWO-TOED SLOTH
000002	*Dendrolagus matschiei*	MATSCHIE'S TREE KANGAROO
000001	*Trichechus manatus*	CARIBBEAN MANATEE
000003	*Bradypus variegatus*	BROWN-THROATED SLOTH
000005	*Myrmecophaga tridactyla*	GIANT ANTEATER
000053	*Callithrix pygmaea*	PYGMY MARMOSET
000004	*Leontopithecus rosalia*	GOLDEN LION TAMARIN
000011	*Saguinus bicolor*	BARE-FACED TAMARIN
000001	*Saguinus midas*	RED-HANDED TAMARIN
000006	*Saguinus mystax*	MOUSTACHED TAMARIN
000005	*Saguinus oedipus*	COTTON-TOP TAMARIN
000006	*Aotus nancymaae*	NANCY MA'S NIGHT MONKEY
000017	*Chiropotes chiropotes*	RED-BACKED BEARDED SAKI
000010	*Pithecia pithecia*	WHITE-FACED SAKI
000005	*Alouatta seniculus*	VENEZUELAN RED HOWLER
000003	*Sylvilagus floridanus*	EASTERN COTTONTAIL RABBIT
000041	*Desmodus rotundus*	COMMON VAMPIRE BAT
000449	*Carollia perspicillata*	SEBA'S SHORT-TAILED BAT
000001	*Leopardus pardalis*	OCELOT
000002	*Pteronura brasiliensis*	GIANT OTTER
000001	*Pudu pudu*	SOUTHERN PUDU
000008	*Tinamus major*	GREAT TINAMOU
000002	*Crax alberti*	BLUE-BILLED CURASSOW
000004	*Crax globulosa*	WATTLED CURASSOW
000001	*Crax fasciolata*	BARE-FACED CURASSOW
000008	*Pauxi pauxi*	HELMETED CURASSOW / NORTHERN HELMETED CURASSOW
000002	*Meleagris ocellata*	OCELLATED TURKEY
000001	*Argusianus argus*	GREAT ARGUS
000001	*Netta peposaca*	ROSY-BILLED POCHARD
000002	*Anhima cornuta*	HORNED SCREAMER
000001	*Dendrocygna viduata*	WHITE-FACED WHISTLING-DUCK
000002	*Cygnus melancoryphus*	BLACK-NECKED SWAN
000001	*Amazonetta brasiliensis*	BRAZILIAN TEAL
000001	*Oressochen jubatus*	ORINOCO GOOSE
000001	*Netta erythrophthalma*	SOUTHERN POCHARD
000001	*Spatula puna*	PUNA TEAL
000017	*Phoenicopterus ruber*	AMERICAN FLAMINGO
000002	*Gallicolumba luzonica*	LUZON BLEEDING-HEART
000002	*Goura cristata*	WESTERN CROWNED-PIGEON / BLUE CROWNED-PIGEON
000002	*Goura victoria*	VICTORIA CROWNED-PIGEON
000002	*Otidiphaps nobilis*	PHEASANT PIGEON
000004	*Patagioenas speciosa*	SCALED PIGEON
000002	*Starnoenas cyanocephala*	BLUE-HEADED QUAIL-DOVE
000004	*Zentrygon lawrencii*	PURPLISH-BACKED QUAIL-DOVE
000002	*Coua caerulea*	BLUE COUA
000002	*Eurypyga helias*	SUNBITTERN

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6545	74-C-0392	001	The Dallas World Aquarium	21-JUL-2026

000003	*Psophia crepitans*	GRAY-WINGED TRUMPETER
000024	*Eudyptula minor*	LITTLE PENGUIN / BLUE PENGUIN / FAIRY PENGUIN
000008	*Spheniscus demersus*	AFRICAN PENGUIN / CAPE PENGUIN
000004	*Eudocimus ruber*	SCARLET IBIS
000003	*Cochlearius cochlearius*	BOAT-BILLED HERON
000002	*Pelecanus occidentalis*	BROWN PELICAN
000014	*Jacana jacana*	WATTLED JACANA
000002	*Athene cunicularia*	BURROWING OWL
000001	*Megascops asio*	EASTERN SCREECH-OWL
000003	*Pulsatrix perspicillata*	SPECTACLED OWL
000001	*Morphnus guianensis*	CRESTED EAGLE
000001	*Spizaetus ornatus*	ORNATE HAWK-EAGLE
000002	*Spizaetus tyrannus*	BLACK HAWK-EAGLE
000017	*Ramphastos ambiguus*	YELLOW-THROATED TOUCAN
000002	*Spizaetus melanoleucus*	BLACK-AND-WHITE HAWK-EAGLE
000004	*Pharomachrus auriceps*	GOLDEN-HEADED QUETZAL
000002	*Trogon melanurus*	BLACK-TAILED TROGON
000004	*Trogon viridis*	GREEN-BACKED TROGON
000001	*Tockus flavirostris*	EASTERN YELLOW-BILLED HORNBILL
000001	*Anthracoceros albirostris*	ORIENTAL PIED-HORNBILL
000015	*Caryothraustes canadensis*	YELLOW-GREEN GROSBEAK
000003	*Buceros rhinoceros*	RHINOCEROS HORNBILL
000001	*Buceros bicornis*	GREAT HORNBILL
000002	*Buceros hydrocorax*	RUFOUS HORNBILL
000002	*Rhyticeros plicatus*	BLYTH'S HORNBILL
000003	*Momotus momota*	AMAZONIAN MOTMOT
000003	*Aulacorhynchus albivitta*	SOUTHERN EMERALD-TOUCANET / NORTHERN ANDEAN TOUCANET
000003	*Aulacorhynchus sulcatus*	GROOVE-BILLED TOUCANET
000003	*Aulacorhynchus haematopygus*	CRIMSON-RUMPED TOUCANET
000002	*Aulacorhynchus coeruleicinctis*	BLUE-BANDED TOUCANET
000017	*Pteroglossus inscriptus*	LETTERED ARACARI
000010	*Pteroglossus viridis*	GREEN ARACARI
000005	*Pteroglossus azara*	IVORY-BILLED ARACARI
000007	*Pteroglossus castanotis*	CHESTNUT-EARED ARACARI
000011	*Pteroglossus aracari*	BLACK-NECKED ARACARI
000002	*Pteroglossus torquatus*	COLLARED ARACARI
000001	*Pteroglossus frantzii*	FIERY-BILLED ARACARI
000002	*Pteroglossus pluricinctus*	MANY-BANDED ARACARI
000008	*Pteroglossus beauharnaisii*	CURL-CRESTED ARACARI
000003	*Pteroglossus bailloni*	SAFFRON TOUCANET
000003	*Andigena laminirostris*	PLATE-BILLED MOUNTAIN-TOUCAN
000003	*Selenidera maculirostris*	SPOT-BILLED TOUCANET
000005	*Ramphastos sulfuratus*	KEEL-BILLED TOUCAN
000009	*Ramphastos vitellinus*	CHANNEL-BILLED TOUCAN
000001	*Ramphastos dicolorus*	RED-BREASTED TOUCAN
000002	*Ramphastos toco*	TOCO TOUCAN
000012	*Melanerpes cruentatus*	YELLOW-TUFTED WOODPECKER
000001	*Psittrichas fulgidus*	PESQUET'S PARROT
000002	*Ara glaucogularis*	BLUE-THROATED MACAW
000002	*Ara macao*	SCARLET MACAW

Species Inspected

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6545	74-C-0392	001	The Dallas World Aquarium	21-JUL-2026

000001	*Amazona oratrix*	YELLOW-HEADED PARROT / YELLOW-HEADED AMAZON / DOUBLE YELLOW-HEADED AMAZON
000001	*Deroptyus accipitrinus*	RED-FAN PARROT
000002	*Calyptorhynchus banksii*	RED-TAILED BLACK-COCKATOO
000008	*Chiroxiphia lanceolata*	LANCE-TAILED MANAKIN
000005	*Ceratopipra erythrocephala*	GOLDEN-HEADED MANAKIN
000001	*Cephalopterus penduliger*	LONG-WATTLED UMBRELLABIRD
000008	*Cyanerpes caeruleus*	PURPLE HONEYCREEPER
000004	*Lipaugus vociferans*	SCREAMING PIHA
000010	*Perissocephalus tricolor*	CAPUCHINBIRD
000002	*Phoenicircus carnifex*	GUIANAN RED-COTINGA
000001	*Pipreola formosa*	HANDSOME FRUITEATER
000005	*Querula purpurata*	PURPLE-THROATED FRUITCROW
000018	*Rupicola peruvianus*	ANDEAN COCK-OF-THE-ROCK
000019	*Rupicola rupicola*	GUIANAN COCK-OF-THE-ROCK
000002	*Xipholena punicea*	POMPADOUR COTINGA
000004	*Cissa hypoleuca*	INDOCHINESE GREEN-MAGPIE / YELLOW-BREASTED MAGPIE
000006	*Cyanocorax affinis*	BLACK-CHESTED JAY
000003	*Cicinnurus magnificus*	MAGNIFICENT BIRD-OF-PARADISE
000003	*Cicinnurus regius*	KING BIRD-OF-PARADISE
000001	*Lophorina superba*	GREATER LOPHORINA
000005	*Paradisaea minor*	LESSER BIRD-OF-PARADISE
000001	*Paradisaea raggiana*	RAGGIANA BIRD-OF-PARADISE
000002	*Leucopsar rothschildi*	BALI MYNA
000001	*Euphonia cayennensis*	GOLDEN-SIDED EUPHONIA
000020	*Euphonia violacea*	VIOLACEOUS EUPHONIA
000002	*Chlorophonia cyanea*	BLUE-NAPED CHLOROPHONIA
000010	*Cacicus haemorrhous*	RED-RUMPED CACIQUE
000004	*Icterus icterus*	VENEZUELAN TROUPIAL
000003	*Psarocolius decumanus*	CRESTED OROPENDOLA
000001	*Psarocolius montezuma*	MONTEZUMA OROPENDOLA
000001	*Psarocolius viridis*	GREEN OROPENDOLA
000020	*Chrysomus icterocephalus*	YELLOW-HOODED BLACKBIRD
000005	*Anisognathus somptuosus*	BLUE-WINGED MOUNTAIN TANAGER
000004	*Cyanerpes cyaneus*	RED-LEGGED HONEYCREEPER
000008	*Dacnis cayana*	BLUE DACNIS
000001	*Ramphocelus bresilius*	BRAZILIAN TANAGER
000020	*Ramphocelus carbo*	SILVER-BEAKED TANAGER
000004	*Ramphocelus dimidiatus*	CRIMSON-BACKED TANAGER
000004	*Ramphocelus flammigerus*	FLAME-RUMPED TANAGER
000006	*Schistochlamys melanopis*	BLACK-FACED TANAGER
000002	*Sporophila lineola*	LINED SEEDEATER
000003	*Tangara arthus*	GOLDEN TANAGER
000010	*Stilpnia cayana*	BURNISHED-BUFF TANAGER / RUFOUS-CROWNED TANAGER
000002	*Tangara chilensis*	PARADISE TANAGER
000012	*Tangara gyrola*	BAY-HEADED TANAGER
000010	*Tangara mexicana*	TURQUOISE TANAGER
000015	*Thraupis palmarum*	PALM TANAGER
000024	*Thraupis episcopus*	BLUE-GRAY TANAGER

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6545	74-C-0392	001	The Dallas World Aquarium	21-JUL-2026

000001	*Tersina viridis*	SWALLOW TANAGER
000001	*Tangara rufigenis*	RUFOUS-CHEEKED TANAGER
000001	*Paroaria coronata*	RED-CRESTED CARDINAL
000001	*Cardinalis phoeniceus*	VERMILION CARDINAL
000008	*Cacicus cela*	YELLOW-RUMPED CACIQUE
000002	*Aburria aburri*	WATTLED GUAN
000001	*Oreophasis derbianus*	HORNED GUAN
000004	*Tauraco fischeri*	FISCHER'S TURACO
000001	*Spatula versicolor*	SILVER TEAL
000002	*Ptilinopus magnificus*	WOMPOO FRUIT-DOVE
000002	*Tauraco leucolophus*	WHITE-CRESTED TURACO
000002	*Balaeniceps rex*	SHOEBILL
000001	*Harpia harpyja*	HARPY EAGLE
000003	*Aulacorhynchus prasinus*	NORTHERN EMERALD-TOUCANET
000001	*Pseudopipra pipra*	WHITE-CROWNED MANAKIN
000002	*Pipra filicauda*	WIRE-TAILED MANAKIN
000003	*Cotinga cayana*	SPANGLED COTINGA
000003	*Icterus cayanensis*	EPAULET ORIOLE
000001	*Zentrygon chiriquensis*	CHIRIQUI QUAIL-DOVE

001294 **Total**